

From Complex Structures to Fiction: A Spatial Approach to European Storytelling

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Abstract

Contemporary Europe is traversed by scientific, technological, energy, economic, and institutional structures distributed across different territories and difficult to observe in their entirety from any single local scale. This work proposes taking such structures as the starting point for constructing narratives set within the European space. The method uses a shared Geographic Information System (GIS) in which existing structures, or sufficiently plausible future developments of them, are reconstructed through their components, geographic distribution, and relations. The process can be summarized as real structure → GIS reconstruction → observation → narrative possibility → story. The map is therefore not constructed to represent an already existing story: observation of the structure precedes the story and contributes to its generation. As a first case study, the paper presents the geographic reconstruction of the nuclear fuel cycle and the subsequent development of the story Quantum Reactor. Finally, the GIS constitutes an open and extensible environment in which structures and narratives can accumulate independently, allowing different stories to share and traverse the same representation of European space.